AMJAD KHALILIAH

Fintech Technical Lead | AI & Solution Architect | Startup Founder

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Innovative Fintech Technical Lead, Software Architect, and Startup Founder with 5+ years of hands-on experience engineering and scaling mission-critical banking platforms, real-time payment solutions, and enterprise microservices. Proven track record at Bank of Palestine driving digital banking transformation, architecting AI-powered fraud prevention and automated KYC systems, and leading high-velocity engineering teams. Founder of FacePal, an AI-driven biometric payment and remittance platform. Adept at bridging modern distributed architectures (Java/Spring Boot, Python/FastAPI, AWS, Docker) with rigorous regulatory and compliance frameworks (PMA Regulatory Sandbox, iDplus eKYC, PCI-DSS).

CORE COMPETENCIES & TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Fintech & Banking Systems:** Core Banking Systems, Temenos Kony Digital Banking, Real-Time Payment Gateways, eKYC & AML Verification, Fraud Detection Engines, Biometric 'Smile-to-Pay' Protocols, PMA Regulatory Sandbox Compliance.
- **Architecture & Backend:** Microservices Architecture, Event-Driven Systems, RESTful API Gateways, Java (Spring Boot), Python (FastAPI, Flask), Node.js, Enterprise Application Integration, Scalable System Design.
- **Low-Code & Process Automation:** Appian Development (Certified Associate Developer), OutSystems Solution Architecture & Governance, n8n Workflow Orchestration & Data Synchronization.
- **AI, Machine Learning & Vision:** Computer Vision, Biometric Face & Liveness Detection, Transaction Anomaly Detection, Signature Extraction & Verification, NLP, Synthetic Data Generation (CTGAN).
- **Cloud, DevOps & Infrastructure:** AWS Cloud Infrastructure (EC2, S3, ECS/EKS), Docker Containerization, CI/CD Pipeline Automation, Git Branching Strategies, System Reliability & 99.9% Uptime Engineering.
- **Databases & Data Modeling:** Oracle Database, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Qdrant Vector DB, Enterprise Data Modeling & Schema Design.

STARTUP & ENTREPRENEURIAL EXPERIENCE

FacePal — *Ramallah, Palestine* **Sep 2025 – Present**

Founder & Chief Executive Officer (CEO)

- Founded and spearheaded **FacePal**, an AI-powered fintech platform delivering contactless 'smile-to-pay' biometric transactions and low-cost direct diaspora remittances.
- Architected end-to-end payment processing pipelines integrating computer vision facial liveness detection with offline QR and NFC fallback mechanisms, guaranteeing 100% transaction continuity in low-connectivity environments.
- Led regulatory engagement and compliance documentation for the **Palestine Monetary Authority (PMA) Regulatory Sandbox**, integrating the solution directly with the national **iDplus** digital identity and eKYC framework.
- Partnered with cloud infrastructure engineers to design containerized, highly resilient microservices on AWS, optimizing transaction latency to under 300ms while adhering strictly to PCI-DSS and data privacy mandates.
- Selected for the prestigious **Intersect Innovation Hub (Startups-In-Residence – STIR)** program; delivered investor pitches and technical demonstrations to regional venture capital funds (e.g., Ibtikar Fund).

ENTERPRISE FINTECH & BANKING EXPERIENCE

Bank of Palestine — *Ramallah, Palestine*

Dec 2021 – Present

Senior Software Engineer / Acting Technical Lead

- Lead technical architecture and engineering execution for core banking applications and digital channels, mentoring and coordinating 8+ software engineers and QA specialists to maintain 100% on-time milestone delivery.
- Architected and deployed enterprise microservices and integration gateways utilizing Java (Spring Boot) and Python, connecting core banking backends with **Temenos Kony Digital Banking**, **Appian**, and **OutSystems** platforms, expanding transactional scalability by 200%.
- Spearheaded comprehensive CI/CD automation and n8n workflow orchestration across enterprise platforms, slashing deployment time by 60%, eliminating deployment errors by 80%, and decreasing system maintenance overhead by 35%.
- Served as a core member of the **AI & Digital Transformation Team**, designing and deploying production-grade AI solutions: automated signature extraction and verification from official forms (reducing onboarding delays by 70%) and the **BankSealer** real-time transaction fraud detection framework.
- Engineered and maintained robust security standards, achieving 90% compliance across regulatory audits, implementing strict API authentication protocols, and maintaining 99.9% core system uptime.
- Standardized enterprise Git branching workflows, test-driven development (TDD), and code review criteria, boosting developer throughput by 25% and reducing code review turnaround by 30%.

FEATURED FINTECH & BLOCKCHAIN PROJECTS

- **PAL-DFI (Palestinian Decentralized Financial Identity):** Designed consortium blockchain architecture and smart contracts on Hyperledger Fabric for verifiable credential lifecycle management, establishing decentralized trust for financial institutions and the PMA.
- **BankSealer Transaction Fraud Guardian:** Built a real-time anomaly detection engine combining Python ML inference models with Spring Boot banking microservices, providing sub-second fraud risk scoring on live payment streams.
- **High-Throughput Banking Document Conversion Service:** Architected, built, and load-tested an asynchronous document transformation microservice using FastAPI and Java Appian plugins, handling high-volume loan contracts and account statements.

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

- **Cloud, AI & Machine Learning:** AWS Certified AI Practitioner / Machine Learning • IBM AI Developer Professional Certificate • Applied Data Science Specialization (IBM / Coursera) • Python for Data Science, AI & Development (IBM) • Intermediate Machine Learning (Kaggle).
- **Data Engineering & Analytics:** Data Analyst Nanodegree (Udacity) • Introduction to Data Engineering (AWS) • IBM Data Analyst Specialization (IBM / Coursera) • Advanced Data Science Specialization (Coursera).
- **Software Development & Architecture:** Appian Certified Associate Developer • Software Engineer Certificate (HackerRank) • Java Web Services & Architecture (Experts Turnkey Solutions) • Java Design Patterns (Udemy) • Full-Stack JavaScript (Udemy).

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Software Engineering

2017 – 2021

Palestine Technical University | **Thesis:** *Smart Home Application using Machine Learning* (Developed IoT-based automation system with predictive analytics for real-time energy optimization)